

14 > Level Design

their load status and visibility. You can use this window to add, remove, or load sublevels, change their hierarchy, and more.

3. Creating Sublevels

When your game environment becomes large or complex, it's good practice to break it down into sublevels. To create a sublevel, open the Levels Window, and select 'Create New'. Give your sublevel a name and start populating it with assets and functionality.

4. Level Streaming

UE5 supports Level Streaming, a feature that dynamically loads and unloads sublevels based on player location or other conditions. This feature is crucial for large, open-world games, as it allows only the necessary parts of the game world to be loaded at any given time, improving performance.

5. Working with World Composition

For very large open-world games, UE5 offers World Composition. This tool automates the management of large landscapes by dividing them into tiles, each of which is treated as a separate sublevel. World Composition then takes care of loading and unloading these tiles based on the player's location.

6. Using Level Blueprints

Each level and sublevel in UE5 has an associated Level Blueprint, a visual scripting tool that allows you to add interactivity and functionality to the level. When working with multiple levels, it's essential to keep Level Blueprint logic well-organized and clear, as it can become quite complex.

7. Leveraging Multi-User Editing

When working with a team, UE5's Multi-User Editing feature is a boon. It allows multiple designers to work on different levels simultaneously, which can drastically speed up development time.

8. Asset Management

Remember that each level contains assets (3D models, materials, sound files, etc.). Managing these assets across multiple levels is critical. Make use of UE5's built-in tools for asset management, including the Content Browser and Asset Dependencies Viewer.

World settings

Unreal Engine 5 (UE5) offers a plethora of features to build immersive, engaging virtual worlds. An essential aspect of creating these environments is the World Settings panel, which provides controls for fine-tuning the specific parameters of your game world. Let's delve into some of these settings and explore how they can shape your UE5 project.

1. Accessing World Settings

You can access the World Settings panel by navigating to 'Window' > 'World Settings' from the main menu in UE5. The

panel will appear on the right side of the screen. If it's not visible, ensure you're in the Level Editor workspace.

2. Game Mode

Game Mode is one of the key settings you'll encounter. This setting determines the basic rules of your game. Here, you can define the default pawn, player controller, game state, player state, and more. These classes will control how your game functions at a basic level.

3. Lighting

In the World Settings panel, you can also adjust the lighting settings for your game world. This includes the Lightmass settings, which control global illumination in your scene. These settings can have a substantial impact on the visual appearance of your game.

4. Physics

UE5 gives you control over physics settings such as gravity, friction, and air resistance. You can set these parameters on a global scale or individually for each object in the world.

5. World Composition

For large landscapes, UE5 offers the World Composition tool. This allows for the automatic handling of large-scale level streaming, dividing your landscape into manageable tiles. Enable World Composition in the World Settings panel if you're working on an open-world project.

6. Navigation

The Navigation section in the World Settings panel controls how AI characters move and navigate the world. Here you can set the default navigation data class and modify the generation settings of the navigation mesh.

7. Level Streaming

The Level Streaming settings control how your sublevels are loaded and unloaded during gameplay. This is crucial for performance, especially in larger games.

8. Layers

The Layers section allows you to assign assets or groups of assets to specific layers. This is useful for organizing your content and can assist in various tasks such as lighting and rendering.

9. World Bounds

Here, you can set the maximum bounds for your game world. Objects outside these bounds will not be rendered, helping improve performance.

Changing the default level

In Unreal Engine 5 (UE5), each new project starts with a default level. However, as your game development progresses, you may